

The author of the book 'Kiratarjuniya' is Bharavi. The story of this book is taken from the Mahabharata. It describes the battle between Arjuna and Shiva in form of "Kirat".

8. The author of 'Prithviraj Raso' is –

- (a) Kalhana (b) Bilhana
(c) Jayanaka (d) Chand Bardai

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

Prithviraj Raso describes the battles of Prithviraj Chauhan. It was written by Chand Bardai.

Pre-Medieval Period

1. Epigraphic records (Inscriptions) suggest that in ancient India, the rulers of Bihar had contact with –

- (a) Burma (b) Thailand
(c) Cambodia (d) Java-Sumatra

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

The Pala king Devpala was Buddhist. He donated five villages at the request of Java king Balputradeva of Sailendra Dynasty for developing a Buddhist Vihar in Nalanda.

2. Consider the following statements regarding the Vikramshila University in Bihar :

1. It was located in the present-day Banka district of Bihar.
2. It was established by King Gopala I of the Pala dynasty.
3. The 'Vajrayana' sect of Buddhism flourished here.
4. Other subjects like Astronomy, Logic, Law, Grammar and Philosophy were also taught here.

Which of the above statements are incorrect ?

- (a) 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 4
(c) 1 and 2 (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Vikramshila University is located in Bhagalpur and not in the Banka district. It was established by Dharmapala of Pal dynasty and not by Gopala I. Hence Statement 1 and 2 are incorrect. Rest are correct.

3. Which ruler of Bengal founded the ancient University called 'Vikramshila.'

- (a) Dharmapala (b) Gopala
(c) Devpala (d) Mahipala

43rd B. P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

King Dharmapala 770-810 A.D. of Pala dynasty established the Vikramshila University. After the downfall of Nalanda University. Vikramshila University was developed as the main centre for the Buddhist religion.

4. The Vikramshila University was established by

- (a) Gopala (b) Dharmapala
(c) Devapala (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. The Huna King Toramana was defeated by the Aulikara King

- (a) Yasodharman
(b) Prakasadharmar
(c) Rajyavardhana
(d) Vishnuvardhana
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (b)

Toramana was a Huna king who ruled in northern India. Sanjeli inscription of Toramana speaks of his conquest and control over Malwa and Gujarat. His territory also included Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan and Kashmir. According to the Risthal inscription, discovered in 1983, Huna king Toramana was defeated by Aulikara king Prakashadharma of Malwa.

2. MEDIEVAL HISTORY OF INDIA

Muslim Invasion on India

1. Muhammad Ghori granted first Iqta in India to –

- (a) Tajuddin Yalduz (b) Qutbuddin Aibak
(c) Shamsuddin Iltutmish (d) Nazir-ud-din Qubacha

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Soon after the victories of Ghori, Iqta system was established in North India. In 1192 A.D., Muhammad Sam of Ghori (Muhammad Ghori) appointed Qutb-ud-Din-Aibak (Qutbuddin Aibak), as in charge of his Indian territories. He played an important role in the second battle of Tarain. Pleased with his works, Ghori appointed him the administrator of Kuhram and Samana. He had taken care of the administration of North Indian territories conquered by them as representative of Ghori till 1206. During this period, Aibak also expanded Turkish power in northern India.